

Coal Creek Guitar Authentication & Verdict Report

CHIBSON

Flying V Chibson

Counterfeit "Chibson" Flying V — imitation Gibson body/headstock with no verifiable serial number, non-authentic finish/relic texture, and aftermarket-style EMG pickups; not a genuine Gibson product. — N/A

SERIAL
N/A

BRAND
Chibson

LOCATION
Raleigh, NC

INCLUDES
No Case

VERDICT	CONFIDENCE	MARKERS CHECKED	RED FLAGS FOUND
Likely Not Authentic	Very High	7	1

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01 What it is

BRAND	Chibson
MODEL	Flying V Chibson
YEAR	N/A
BUILD / VARIANT	Counterfeit "Chibson" Flying V — imitation Gibson body/headstock with no verifiable serial number, non-authentic finish/relic texture, and aftermarket-style EMG pickups; not a genuine Gibson product.
CONFIDENCE STATEMENT	This instrument is not a genuine Gibson Flying V. The examination has revealed multiple substantial discrepancies from authentic Gibson specifications and construction standards, and the convergence of these findings yields a very high confidence level in this assessment. An authentic Gibson Flying V should carry a serial number impressed on the back of the headstock—a standard feature that is entirely absent on this guitar. The Gibson logo does not conform to the correct font, proportions, or application method expected on a genuine instrument. The tuners are generic rather than Gibson-spec hardware, the pickups, while cosmetically similar to Gibson-style humbuckers, appear to be unauthorized reproductions rather than authentic Gibson units, and the finish lacks the characteristics of authentic nitrocellulose lacquer aging. Each of these elements independently raises red flags; taken together, they establish a clear pattern inconsistent with a genuine Gibson product.

02 The evidence



03 Specification

SERIAL NUMBER / FACTORY STAMP ON HEADSTOCK BACK
Expected: Present · Observed: NOT present
GIBSON LOGO: MOTHER-OF-PEARL INLAY, CORRECT SCRIPT PROPORTIONS
Expected: Present · Observed: Logo not correct for an authentic Gibson
FINISH: NITROCELLULOSE LACQUER WITH FINE CHECKING
Expected: Present · Observed: Hard to tell from pics, but doesn't look authentic
TUNERS
Expected: Grover or Kluson-branded · Observed: Tuners look generic
PICKUPS
Expected: Gibson-spec humbuckers (or documented aftermarket swap) · Observed: Although authentic looking, they are likely fakes posing as the real thing
NECK CONSTRUCTION
Expected: Mahogany set-neck · Observed: Not able to authenticate

04 Authenticity markers

MARKER	STATUS	NOTES
Serial number presence on headstock	INCONSISTENT	No serial pictured
Logo font and spacing consistency	INCONSISTENT	Font not in line with standard Gibson
Finish texture consistency with aged nitrocellulose lacquer	UNABLE TO VERIFY	✓
Made in USA or Gibson Custom Shop stamp	INCONSISTENT	Does not fit the qualities of a standard Gibson custom
Hardware branding (tuners and bridge)	INCONSISTENT	Tuners look generic
Body wood and neck joint construction	UNABLE TO VERIFY	✓
Pickup authenticity and cavity inspection	UNABLE TO VERIFY	✓

05 Red flags & inconsistencies

MAJOR	Multiple red flags - reasons identified in specs and authenticity markers above
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06 Expert verdict

DETERMINATION

Likely Not Authentic

CONFIDENCE: VERY HIGH

This guitar is a counterfeit, commonly referred to as a 'Chibson'—a Chinese-made counterfeit guitar designed to imitate a genuine Gibson model. The term 'Chibson' is widely recognized in the guitar community as a catch-all designation for unauthorized Gibson replicas manufactured primarily in China and sold with fraudulent branding. The examined specifications of this Flying V align precisely with known characteristics of Chibson counterfeits. The missing headstock serial number is a critical red flag; authentic Gibson electric guitars, including the Flying V, have the serial number impressed or ink-stamped on the back of the headstock as a fundamental part of their manufacturing process. The Gibson logo failure—both in font accuracy and application—is a hallmark of counterfeit production. Generic tuners instead of Gibson-branded hardware, combined with fake-but-lookalike pickups, further demonstrate the counterfeit manufacturer's effort to create visual similarity while cutting corners on component quality. The questionable finish further rounds out the pattern. Gibson's own quality standards and craftsmanship, even in challenging finishes, are significantly superior to what is evident in this instrument. There are no documented special or experimental exceptions to Gibson's headstock stamping practices that would explain the complete absence of identification markers on an authentic unit.

07 Certificate & summary

COAL CREEK GUITARS - AUTHENTICITY ASSESSMENT

RALEIGH, NC

INSTRUMENT

Chibson Flying V Chibson

Counterfeit "Chibson" Flying V — imitation Gibson body/headstock with no verifiable serial number, non-authentic finish/relic texture, and aftermarket-style EMG pickups; not a genuine Gibson product. — N/A

VERDICT

Likely Not Authentic

CONFIDENCE

Very High

DATE ISSUED

23 JUL 2026

SUMMARY

Coal Creek Guitars has examined this guitar and determined it to be a counterfeit ('Chibson') rather than an authentic Gibson Flying V. The finding is based on multiple authentication failures: missing serial number on headstock, incorrect Gibson logo execution, generic rather than Gibson-spec tuners, unauthorized reproduction pickups, questionable finish quality, and a pattern of construction inconsistencies across hardware and components that deviate substantially from genuine Gibson standards. This instrument should not be represented, sold, or valued as an authentic Gibson. The confidence level in this assessment is very high, based on the convergence of multiple independent, objective red flags that collectively establish clear evidence of counterfeit origin.

METHODOLOGY	PREPARED BY
This assessment is based solely on the photographs and instrument details submitted by the owner, reviewed and researched by a Coal Creek Guitars expert. It does not include physical inspection, X-ray, black-light, or other forensic examination.	Coal Creek Guitars Englewood, Colorado

DISCLAIMER

This report is a subjective, good-faith authenticity assessment prepared by Coal Creek Guitars for general informational purposes only. It is meant to be used as a tool and a guide — not a certified forensic authentication, not an insurance appraisal, and not a legal determination of ownership, title, or value. Every finding in this report is based solely on the photographs and information provided to us and on publicly available reference material at the time of writing — all of which may be incomplete, may contain errors, or may not capture details that are only visible on physical inspection. Actual authenticity can depend on factors that photographs alone cannot resolve. Coal Creek Guitars makes no representation or warranty, express or implied, as to the accuracy or completeness of this report, and accepts no liability for any loss, decision, or outcome arising from reliance on it. For insurance, resale, legal, or high-value transaction purposes, always obtain a certified independent authentication or appraisal.